

your chair, which is not a good thing. In the 15-inch category, not a single monitor had this useful feature. It wasn't much better in the 17-inch category, either—just three panels, the HCL, the NEC and the Philips, had the height adjustment feature. You can adjust the height of these monitors by about 11 cm.

Horizontal and vertical swivel is another good feature found in a few LCD monitors. Most monitors allow for vertical tilt, but very few allow for horizontal swivel. In the 15-inch segment, the Digiview was the only monitor that had both horizontal and vertical swivel. The rest came with the provision only for vertical tilt. Amongst the 17-inches, again, just two brands—HCL and NEC—offered horizontal as well as vertical tilt.

Other Features

These days, some graphics cards, including even some entry-level ones, come with the DVI interface.

If the monitor

will be forced to feed it to the monitor through the D-sub connector. In the 17-inches, the BenQ, NEC and Philips had DVI inputs.

Power Consumption

A salesman selling an LCD monitor will never forget to mention the power consumption rating of LCD monitors vis-à-vis CRT monitors. It is a fact that LCD panels consume less power compared to CRT monitors, but it is also true that the power requirements are often not substantially lower.

Fifteen-inch LCDs need anything between 21W and 35W. Seventeen-inches need between 40W to 60W of power, which, compared to the 64W needed by the Philips 107E5 CRT monitor, is just a small improvement.

Always remember to check the power rating of the LCD you are thinking of investing in, and note whether there is substantial power saving possible. Of course, for a home user, this doesn't make



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CMV CT-529A

has a DVI input, there is no signal conversion happening in the monitor, so the overall image quality is much better than with the D-sub interface. Sadly, none of the monitors in the 15-inch category had a separate DVI interface to accept a pure-digital signal from a graphics card.

This means that even if you have a graphics card that can deliver a pure-digital signal, you

too much difference—it's in an office, where several monitors are deployed, that power costs add up to make a difference.

How They Fared

The monitors were tested using DisplayMate Video Edition and the Passmark monitor test utility, along with several real-world tests—these included the viewing angle test and looking for the ghosting effect during movies.

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